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A school day in San Mateo, Calif. More than 1,400 school districts have filed lawsuits against leading social media companies.

At School, Apps Pushed Teens to Stay on Screens

By JENNIFER VALENTINO-DeVRIES

Snapchat sent phone alerts to adolescents during school hours, urging them to share what was going on in their classrooms.

Meta paid “teen ambassadors” to promote Instagram and hand out swag to their friends at school.

TikTok gave the National PTA millions of dollars, in part to throw school events about online safety and provide favorable comments to journalists.

Again and again, the world's leading social media companies have targeted stu-

Tech Giants Made Students Their Targets, Files Show

dents, even as complaints have mounted that they are hurting teenagers’ mental health and academic performance, according to a New York Times review of internal documents that lay bare for the first time these tactics to hook young users.

The documents emerged from lawsuits filed by more than 1,400 school districts against Meta, Snap, TikTok and YouTube

amid a rising backlash against social media, with parent movements and best-selling books blaming the platforms for loneliness, bullying, eating disorders and sexual exploitation.

The outcry, long focused on social media's harm to mental health, has now shifted to its upending of the classroom. Many school districts are banning smartphones, and some are re-evaluating their reliance on devices like Chromebooks, the inexpensive laptops made by YouTube's parent company, Google.

The companies’ push to keep children

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Trusted Tellers Shield Clients From Scams

By TARA SIEGEL BERNARD

SCARSDALE, N.Y. — Karen Battista and Angela Castaldo have spent a combined 47 years behind the teller counter at a Chase branch in Scarsdale, N.Y., an affluent suburb just north of Manhattan. They know which customers just returned from vacation, whose children were recently married and who just lost a beloved dog.

Just before closing time on a cold February afternoon, one of their longtime customers, then 81 and recently widowed, walked up to Ms. Battista's station. The woman needed to transfer \$9,000 into a new account. She slid her debit card into the reader on the counter, but when Ms. Battista searched for a new account under her name, nothing came up.

What the customer shared next provided some clues: Before coming in, she said, she received a call from Chase — at least that was what it said on her cellphone's caller ID. The caller asked if she had made three transfers for \$1,000 each via Zelle, the bank's digital payment service, something she had never used.

The caller then transferred the customer to a man who called himself “Michael” and who said he would open a new account for her to safeguard her money from fraudsters. But she'd have to go into a branch to transfer \$9,000 into the new account.

After digesting the details, Ms.

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JEREMIE SOUTEYRAT FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

Among England's roughly 800 thatchers, like Christopher Essex, above, it's tradition or adaptation.

In English Thatchers’ Fight, It’s Straw vs. Reed

By RUKMINI CALLIMACHI

REDGRAVE, England — If you were buying a house in a notoriously rainy country, would you choose one with a roof made of straw?

Across England, buyers are paying extraordinary sums to do exactly that. Thatched homes, once associated with peasant life, are now among the most coveted properties in a country where nostalgia for a distant and mythologized past runs deep — a story-

book landscape of shires, low beams and misty sheep meadows. In April, the actress Sienna Miller re-listed her thatched cottage in Buckinghamshire for 1.75 million pounds (\$2.35 million). So enduring is the appeal that Richard Branson, the billionaire founder of Virgin Group, hired British thatchers to roof his Caribbean home.

But beneath the layers of thatch, a feud is simmering among England's tiny fraternity of so-called master thatchers.

For the most ardent traditional-

ists, the only true thatch is “long straw” — typically cereal straw, like wheat, which is threshed to remove the grain — believed by historians to be England's original roof. Then there's water reed, the more durable alternative that is increasingly imported from abroad.

For the master thatcher Stephen Letch, the difference is unmistakable. The problem is that for almost everyone else it's undetectable — which is one reason long-straw roofs are going extinct.

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Deportations Cramp Courts Around U.S.

Worry Over Due Process as Caseloads Surge

By JAZMINE ULLOA and HAMED ALEAZIZ

CHICAGO — Federal officials have quietly begun fast-tracking cases through immigration courts, pushing dozens of additional cases onto the dockets on certain days in an effort to more quickly process asylum and other claims.

The fast-tracking, which is also intended to increase the pace of deportations, started without any formal notification or announcement from the Trump administration, according to immigration lawyers and court officials interviewed by The New York Times. But a surge of cases has been apparent in numerous courts around the country. Some judges have seen their caseloads double and triple, prompting worries that cases are being rushed through, violating due process rights.

At separate courthouses in Annandale and Sterling, Va., in recent days, Times reporters observed long lines and packed dockets. Some immigration judges saw their caseloads more than double, with as many as 100 adults waiting for their cases to be heard. In Annandale, the caseloads have included dozens of unaccompanied minors.

Lines were also evident at a courthouse in downtown Chicago on a recent weekday, with families spilling out of waiting areas and into hallways. Many cases were being processed in small groups, or in several instances with more than two dozen people appearing at once.

And in New Orleans, lawyers saw the number of cases increase to more than 200 last Monday and Tuesday in one courtroom alone. The judges at that courthouse typically take only about 30 to 40 cases per day, lawyers said. The morning dockets were so packed and chaotic that lawyers wishing to observe or monitor the proceedings were not allowed in to watch.

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Democrats’ Dilemma: Preserve Diversity or Pursue More Seats?

By CLYDE McGRADY

COLUMBIA, S.C. — South Carolina Democrats at Representative James Clyburn's “World Famous Fish Fry” just over a week ago were feeling triumphant.

Mr. Clyburn, South Carolina's longest serving Black lawmaker and the state's lone Democrat in Congress, had survived a failed redistricting attempt by state Republicans determined to act after the Supreme Court weakened protections under the Voting Rights Act for majority-Black districts.

So as the sun set on a terrace above the Congaree River, in Columbia, a crowd of Black women line danced to 803Fresh's “Boots on the Ground,” while hot grease popping in deep fryers sent a thick smell of fish through the late-spring air.

But the next act in the drama over Black representation will be driven in part by Democratic leaders, some of them Black, who face a difficult decision.

Do they preserve the majority-Black, overwhelmingly Democratic districts in blue states like New York, Illinois, Maryland and New Jersey? Or do they maximize Democratic representation in the

WIN FOR TRUMP IN A LONG FEUD WITH THE I.R.S.

KEEPS AUDIT IMMUNITY

An Enormously Valuable Benefit for a President and His Family

By ANDREW DUEHREN

WASHINGTON — Senate Republican anger about President Trump's \$1.8 billion fund for people who claim to be victims of federal overreach was loud and apparent.

It held up the Republican agenda in Congress for weeks, and during a marathon voting session on Thursday and early Friday, several Republicans voted to end the fund, though those efforts failed. Still, the furor forced the acting attorney general, Todd Blanche, to announce last week that he was abandoning it entirely.

Not so for the sweeping protections from I.R.S. audits that Mr. Blanche also ordered up for Mr. Trump and his family. On that front, Republican reaction has been much more muted, and Mr. Blanche said the audit shield would stay in place. A Democratic effort to cancel the audit protection failed on a voice vote.

The result is that an apparently unprecedented and enormously valuable public benefit for the president has, so far, flown under the radar in Congress and passed into Mr. Trump's hands without much protest from members of his own party.

Mr. Trump and his family have spent decades aggressively avoiding taxes, according to previous reporting in The New York Times. The newly won ability to escape from Internal Revenue Service examinations could be worth tens of millions of dollars: One audit, ongoing in the days before the new immunity for Mr. Trump was announced, could have resulted in a bill from the government exceeding \$100 million, The Times has reported. Other authorities have had questions, too: In 2022,

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KENNY HOLSTON/THE NEW YORK TIMES

Gregory Meeks, a Democratic New York congressman, is not against reshaping his district.

House by diluting urban districts dominated by Black voters and expanding their boundaries into the suburbs? Doing the latter would allow them to target Republican House members in those states.

Those new districts would remain Democratic, though less so, but they may no longer be majority-Black. So Black voters could

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METROPOLITAN

When the Game Got Serious

Three men who met while playing chess in Central Park formed a bond that helped them battle their demons and fight for one another.

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SUNDAY BUSINESS

Netflix’s Strategy Shift

Dan Lin, the chairman of the company's film division, doesn't fawn over stars or write blank checks. And he still greenlights the most movies.

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WORLD CUP SPECIAL SECTION

The Bedlam of the Beautiful Game

As the World Cup comes to the United States, Mexico and Canada for a 39-day spectacle, the challenges have never been greater, for the players or for the fans.



SUNDAY OPINION

Mara Gay

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Regent

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